

Staged Seminar Activities Rubric

Rubric for the linked group activities across Seminars 1 to 5: paper pool, results presentation, dataset download attempt, and Stata main-results attempt.

Not a full replication assignment

The goal is progressive research skill-building, not perfect reproduction of a published paper.

Group submission logic

Individual paper work begins in Seminar 1, then the group builds shared outputs across later seminars.

Evidence matters

Students should show what they tried, what worked, what failed, and why.

Undergraduate-friendly

Marks reward clear interpretation, careful documentation, and honest reflection.

OVERVIEW

Rubric Structure

This rubric assesses the staged seminar activities as one connected portfolio. Students begin by building a group paper pool, then practise reading results, identifying data, and attempting Stata analysis.

20%	30%	20%	20%	10%
Seminar 1 Group paper pool	Seminars 2-3 Results presentation	Seminar 4 Dataset download	Seminar 5 Stata attempt	Professionalism and reflection

Marking principle: students should not be penalised simply because a dataset is difficult to access or a paper cannot be fully reproduced. They should be assessed on clarity, effort, documentation, interpretation, and honest explanation of limitations.

DETAILED CRITERIA

Performance Rubric

Criterion	Weight	Excellent	Good / Satisfactory	Developing / Needs Work
Seminar 1: Group paper pool. Individual paper walkthroughs and group collation.	20%	Each member selects a clearly relevant and different empirical paper. Responses accurately identify abstract, keywords, literature, gap, hypotheses, design, variables and limitations. PDFs and cover page are complete.	Most papers are suitable and different. Responses cover the main required items, though some discussion may be brief or descriptive. PDFs are mostly complete.	Papers overlap, are unsuitable, or are weakly connected to the course. Responses are incomplete, mostly copied, or missing key items. PDFs or group collation are incomplete.
Seminars 2-3: Results presentation. Reading tables using methods and identification concepts.	30%	Presentation clearly explains Y, X, controls, sample, model, summary statistics, correlations and main coefficients. It gives a strong endogeneity/identification discussion and explains why results are credible or vulnerable.	Presentation identifies the main variables and results with reasonable accuracy. It discusses some endogeneity or design concerns, but may not fully connect them to the paper strongest result.	Presentation summarises the paper without explaining the results table. Key variables or coefficients are unclear. Endogeneity discussion is missing, generic, or inaccurate.
Seminar 4: Dataset download attempt. Moving from paper data description to database query.	20%	Group clearly identifies the dataset, source, table/file, sample period, identifiers and variables. Download attempt is well documented with query choices, screenshots or notes, and a clear account of access/data limitations.	Group identifies a plausible dataset and attempts a download. Documentation covers the main choices, but some details about variables, sample rules or limitations are thin.	Dataset source is unclear or not linked to the paper. Download attempt is poorly documented, or limitations are not explained.
Seminar 5: Stata main-results attempt. Using data to attempt the paper main result.	20%	Do-file and outputs show a clear Stata workflow: preserving raw data, cleaning, constructing variables, summary statistics, correlations, and the closest feasible model. Differences from the paper are explained thoughtfully.	Stata attempt produces some useful outputs and a reasonable model attempt. Workflow is understandable, though variable construction or documentation may be incomplete.	Stata work is minimal, not reproducible, or disconnected from the paper. Outputs are pasted without explanation, or the group does not explain what could not be reproduced.

Criterion	Weight	Excellent	Good / Satisfactory	Developing / Needs Work
Professionalism, integrity and reflection. Organisation, honesty and research practice.	10%	Submission is well organised, properly cited, clearly written and honest about failed attempts. Reflection shows what the group learned about empirical research, data and methods.	Submission is generally clear and complete. Citations and organisation are acceptable. Reflection identifies some learning points but may be brief.	Submission is disorganised, missing citations or unclear about individual/group contributions. Reflection is superficial or hides problems.

SUBMISSION EVIDENCE

What Students Should Submit or Keep

The portfolio should show the development of the group project across the seminars. The exact LMS submission structure can be adjusted, but students should preserve the following evidence.

Seminar 1 Evidence

- Group cover page with members and selected papers.
- One individual response per student.
- PDF copies of all selected papers.

Seminars 2-3 Evidence

- Presentation slides on the paper results section.
- Slide(s) explaining key variables and coefficients.
- Slide(s) explaining endogeneity and identification.

Seminar 4 Evidence

- Dataset source and database path.
- Query choices, selected variables and sample period.
- Downloaded data or notes explaining why download was partial or blocked.

Seminar 5 Evidence

- Raw file and working Stata dataset where available.
- Do-file or command log.
- Summary statistics, correlations and attempted main results table.

INSTRUCTOR NOTES

Suggested Grading Interpretation

Score Range	Interpretation	Typical Evidence
85-100	Excellent staged research portfolio.	Clear paper reading, strong results interpretation, careful data attempt, reproducible Stata workflow, thoughtful limitations.
70-84	Good and mostly complete portfolio.	Main tasks completed with reasonable accuracy; some parts may be less detailed but the research logic is visible.
55-69	Developing but acceptable attempt.	Some seminar stages are incomplete or descriptive, but the group shows meaningful effort and basic understanding.
Below 55	Incomplete or weak attempt.	Missing key evidence, weak link to the selected paper, little interpretation, or poor documentation of data/Stata work.